

Lance Lacoste

PLATFORM ENGINEERING · SYSTEMS ARCHITECTURE

New Orleans, LA

✉ lance.lacoste@gmail.com | 🏠 lancelacoste.com | 📱 llacoste | 🌐 lancelacoste

Summary

Principal-level platform engineer and systems architect who builds the foundational systems teams quietly depend on — turning sprawling, manual operations into reliable platforms that largely run themselves. 15+ years, from backend engineering into platform and systems architecture, repeatedly bringing infrastructure-as-code, self-service, and self-healing reliability to organizations that had none. Strongest in post-acquisition and high-growth environments, where the mess is real and the leverage is highest.

Core Competencies

Platform & Architecture	Platform Engineering, Internal Developer Platforms (IDP), Platform-as-a-Product, Systems Architecture, Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, Multi-Tenant Systems, Paved Roads & Golden Paths
Infrastructure & Cloud	AWS, Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, Docker, Kafka, CI/CD Systems, Infrastructure as Code, Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), SLO/SLI, Observability (Datadog, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, New Relic)
Engineering Practices	Domain-Driven Design, Test-Driven Development, Spec-Driven Development, AI-Assisted Development
Engineering Leadership	Modernization Initiatives, Technical Strategy, Engineering Standards, Cross-Team Enablement, Mentorship
Languages & Runtimes	Elixir, Python, Ruby, JavaScript, SQL, Bash

Selected Platform Systems

Multi-Tenant Salesforce Synchronization Platform

[Remembers](#)

ELIXIR · OBAN · AWS · TERRAFORM · HEROKU CONNECT

- Sole architect and implementer of bidirectional Salesforce synchronization with full per-tenant isolation across dozens of customer environments — each a dedicated stack (multiple databases plus supporting services) stood up by its own Terraform workspace, eliminating cross-tenant blast radius.
- Designed a self-healing, NOTIFY-driven recovery engine — concurrency-safe job claiming (SKIP LOCKED), idempotent upserts, exponential backoff, and automatic dead-lettering — that recovers failed syncs without manual intervention.
- Built to a KPI-first standard — not considered done until its health and effectiveness were observable on business-metric dashboards, across hundreds of thousands of synced records a day.
- Made the platform fully config-driven: a new synced object is added through configuration — its schema and field validations generated dynamically at runtime — with no code change, while Bulk-API ingestion and incremental delta sync keep Salesforce API usage low.
- Cut Salesforce licensing cost by making the platform the single system that talks to Salesforce — internal services integrate through its simplified interface instead of each provisioning its own Salesforce API access, collapsing many would-be integrations into one.

Internal Self-Service Provisioning Platform

[Remembers](#)

ELIXIR · PHOENIX LIVEVIEW · KUBERNETES · TERRAFORM

- Primary maintainer of a self-service platform that lets Customer Success provision full customer environments without engineering involvement, orchestrating Terraform, Kubernetes on AWS EKS, and container builds via GitHub Actions. Now serving hundreds of environments at over a hundred deployments a day.
- Built a guided new-instance wizard that auto-discovers the databases, hosting, and credentials needed to stand up a synchronization-platform server, collapsing a fiddly, error-prone manual setup into a few validated steps for non-engineers.
- Rebuilt the primary config editor — where Customer Success spends most of its day — for instant load and asynchronous tooling, replacing a slow legacy view.
- Automated workflows that were previously done by hand and drove ongoing performance and UI/UX improvements across the operator experience.

Distributed Event Bus & Source of Truth

[Veriforce](#)

KAFKA · EVENT SOURCING · MULTI-CLUSTER DR

- Architected a Kafka-based event bus as the system of record for core business entities across hundreds of microservices, replacing brittle point-to-point integrations with a single durable event log.
- Modeled entities as replayable event streams so downstream services rehydrated their own databases by consuming topics — consumers stay decoupled from producers and can rebuild state on demand.
- Evaluated multiple messaging options and selected Kafka for the throughput, durability, and replayability the source-of-truth model required.
- Scaled it into a highly available, heavily automated deployment — a failover cluster with automated primary-to-secondary replication for disaster recovery, plus automated rebalancing on a schedule and in response to live metrics.

Professional Experience

Remembers

Remote

PRINCIPAL DEVOPS ENGINEER

Sept. 2023 – Present

- Built a centralized webhook intake and routing platform that gave third-party providers a single authenticated entry point, replacing webhook handling duplicated across hundreds of customer-facing applications — with SQS-based delivery, content deduplication, and dead-lettering.
- Designed paved-road CI/CD frameworks and deployment patterns that lifted release cadence and removed per-service operational toil; after the company's acquisition, led the CI/CD modernization of one of the parent organization's business units, partnering with its engineering leadership.
- Introduced a standardized, self-documenting development workflow — a common make-driven toolchain (consistent setup, run, test, and pre-push targets, containerized services, and git hooks) — so engineers could pick up any repository and start contributing without setup friction.
- Mentored engineers and led a recurring knowledge-sharing forum on platform and DevOps practice, raising the baseline across teams.

Veriforce

Covington, LA / Remote

PRINCIPAL DEVOPS ENGINEER

2021 – 2023

- Architected Kubernetes-based deployment infrastructure replacing legacy container orchestration across a post-acquisition engineering organization, giving teams a consistent deploy path.
- Brought the cloud estate under Infrastructure-as-Code from near-zero coverage — into spec and under version control — and standardized deployment workflows across teams.
- Architected the distributed Kafka event bus detailed above — a durable, replayable source of truth that let the application estate rehydrate from the event log instead of point-to-point integration.

iSeatz

New Orleans, LA

LEAD DEVOPS ENGINEER

2017 – 2021

- Set technical direction for the DevOps function — operations and security, roughly nine engineers — and owned the department budget spanning cloud spend, tooling, and headcount.
- Sat on the architecture review board as the DevOps representative, weighing in on system and software-design decisions across the engineering organization.
- Introduced configuration management, Infrastructure-as-Code, and scalable CI/CD to an organization that had none — bringing the cloud estate under version control and auto-provisioning pipelines for new applications.
- Cut cloud operational costs by 20%+ through architectural optimization; led container-orchestration adoption and contributed materially to PCI compliance.
- As part of a broader risk-reduction initiative, introduced an artifact repository (Artifactory) to proxy and cache third-party dependencies — keeping builds reproducible and the supply chain intact even if an upstream package is yanked or a registry goes down.

Lucid

New Orleans, LA

LEAD DEVOPS ENGINEER

2016 – 2017

- Set technical direction and standards across infrastructure and deployment, leading a team of three engineers.
- Architected CI/CD systems and infrastructure standardization patterns supporting organization-wide engineering workflows.
- Reduced cloud infrastructure costs by tens of thousands of dollars per month through architectural redesign.
- Introduced container orchestration to improve deployment consistency and resource utilization.
- Built centralized monitoring with business-facing KPI dashboards — including always-on office displays — so visible that non-engineering staff would flag failing applications from the metrics before engineering noticed.

General Electric • Capital & Oil & Gas

DEVOPS & CONTINUOUS DELIVERY ENGINEER

2015 – 2016

- Architected CI/CD systems supporting customer-facing enterprise applications across two GE business units.
- Built developer onboarding, infrastructure automation, and monitoring tooling that streamlined provisioning, delivery, and pipeline visibility.
- Guided engineering teams in Agile, CI/CD, and test-driven development practices.

Force Multiplier Solutions

New Orleans, LA

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER → SENIOR SOFTWARE ARCHITECT

2011 – 2015

- Led development of fleet management, operational analytics, and customer-facing platforms supporting business operations.
- Managed technical direction and stakeholder engagement across multiple concurrent product workstreams.

Education

University of New Orleans

New Orleans, LA

M.S. COMPUTER SCIENCE

2018

University of New Orleans

New Orleans, LA

B.S. COMPUTER SCIENCE • B.S. MATHEMATICS

2013